

## Scoring Guide for Psychological Assessment

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### Introduction

This booklet provides a structured framework for recording and interpreting responses to thematic assessment tools. It includes categories for Needs, Presses, Emotions, Conflicts, Traits, Frustration, Defence Mechanisms, and Coping Strategies.

Use this guide to systematically document and analyze narrative or projective test responses, facilitating a clearer understanding of underlying psychological dynamics.

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### Section 1: Needs

List of psychological needs commonly expressed in narratives:

1. **Harmavoidance** – Avoid pain, injury, illness, death, or dangerous situations.
  2. **Infavoidance** – Avoid humiliation or embarrassing situations.
  3. **Nurturance** – Helping, caring, or being supportive.
  4. **Order** – Putting things in order, tidiness.
  5. **Play** – Acts of fun, participation in games, making jokes.
  6. **Rejection** – Refusing to accept, excluding, abandoning.
  7. **Sentience** – Enjoying sensation, sensuous experiences.
  8. **Sex** – Interest in sexual activity or erotic relationships.
  9. **Succorance** – Desire to be supported, protected, or insured.
  10. **Understanding** – Analytical thinking, formulating ideas.
  11. **Fantasy** – Wishful thinking.
  12. **Recognition** – Desire to be valued.
  13. **Cognizance** – Curiosity, seeking knowledge.
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### Section 2: Presses (Environmental Pressures)

Common life events or situational pressures that influence behavior:

1. In support
2. Stress

3. Discord
4. Discipline
5. Absence of Parent
6. Illness
7. Death
8. Poverty
9. Misfortune
10. Accident
11. Loss
12. Companionship
13. Rejection
14. Rivalry
15. Birth
16. Maltreatment
17. Litigation
18. Religion
19. Marriage
20. Recognition
21. Friendship
22. Sex
23. Assault
24. Disability
25. Betrayal
26. Inferiority
27. Social pressure
28. Prohibition
29. Shelter/home issues
30. Separation

31. Maladjustment
  32. Possession/possessiveness
  33. Status
  34. Demand
  35. Work
  36. Punishment
  37. Opposition
  38. Economic pressure
  39. Ridicule
  40. Obstacle
  41. Failure
  42. Dispute
  43. Migration
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### **Section 3: Emotions**

Comprehensive list of emotional states:

1. Fear
2. Anger
3. Sorrow
4. Joy
5. Lust
6. Disgust
7. Acceptance
8. Anticipation
9. Surprise
10. Self-pity
11. Shame
12. Envy

13. Kindness
14. Love
15. Hate
16. Pride
17. Pain
18. Pleasure
19. Patience
20. Stress
21. Relationship-based emotions
22. Repentance
23. Security
24. Togetherness
25. Privacy
26. Appreciation
27. Obligation
28. Constraint
29. Apprehension
30. Amusement
31. Comfort
32. Confidence
33. Depression
34. Disappointment
35. Desire
36. Elation
37. Embarrassment
38. Ecstasy
39. Gratitude
40. Grief

41. Guilt
42. Gladness
43. Nervousness
44. Shyness
45. Shock
46. Sadness
47. Terror
48. Unhappiness
49. Anxiety
50. Empathy
51. Sympathy
52. Despair
53. Perplexity
54. Perturbation
55. Enthusiasm
56. Admiration
57. Compassion
58. Boredom
59. Indifference
60. Ambition

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#### **Section 4: Traits**

List of personality traits:

1. Reserved
2. Easygoing
3. Emotional
4. Realistic
5. Anxious

6. Authoritarian
7. Pessimistic
8. Optimistic
9. Enthusiastic
10. Responsible
11. Shy
12. Dependent
13. Bold
14. Practical
15. Attention-seeking
16. Adaptable
17. Suspicious
18. Nature-oriented
19. Tranquil
20. Believes in luck
21. Compromising
22. Concerned
23. Venturesome
24. Independent
25. Social
26. Asocial
27. Rule-evader
28. Superego strength

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## **Section 5: Defence Mechanisms**

Common psychological defences:

1. Repression
2. Suppression

3. Regression
  4. Reaction formation
  5. Conversion
  6. Sublimation
  7. Rationalization
  8. Denial
  9. Identification
  10. Projection
  11. Displacement
  12. Compensation
  13. Fantasy
  14. Isolation
  15. Introjection
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### **Section 6: Types of Conflict**

Psychological conflict categories:

1. Approach–Approach conflict
  2. Approach–Avoidance conflict
  3. Avoidance–Avoidance conflict
  4. Id vs. Superego conflict
  5. Interpersonal conflict
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### **Section 7: Coping Strategies**

Common adaptive and maladaptive coping methods:

1. Using resources to deal with problems
2. Seeking alternative solutions
3. Seeking support from others
4. Seeking help from experts

5. Change of environment
6. Physical activity
7. Mental activity
8. Worship/spiritual practice
9. Acceptance
10. Using defence mechanisms
11. Patience
12. Optimism

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### How to Use This Guide

- **For Clinicians:** Use this framework to score thematic tests (e.g., TAT, storytelling tasks).
- **For Self-Reflection:** Identify recurring themes in personal narratives.
- **For Training:** Teach students to categorize psychological content systematically.

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### Blank Scoring Sheet (Template)

*Copy and use for each assessment:*

| Card No. | Needs | Presses | Emotions | Conflicts | Traits | Frustration | Defence | Coping Strategies |
|----------|-------|---------|----------|-----------|--------|-------------|---------|-------------------|
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